

Syncerus caffer

Cape buffalo



Location E., C., and S. Africa

Length 7¼–11 ft (2.4–3.4 m)
Tail 19½–43 in (50–110 cm)
Weight 770–1,985 lb (350–900 kg)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



Africa's only cowl-like mammal frequents varied habitats at altitudes of up to 13,200 ft (4,000 m). However, the Cape buffalo needs a daily drink and is never farther than about 9 miles (15 km) from water. The male may approach twice

the weight of the female and has more robust horns that meet in a "boss" on the forehead, a thicker neck, a shoulder hump, and a small hanging fringe of hairs on the throat (dewlap). This buffalo feeds at night and at cool periods of the day, on various grasses, leaves, and other herbage. Males posture for females and dominance, and may fight by pressing or ramming heads. Herd members mutually groom and use mainly sound signals for coordinated actions, such as moving on, flight, or warning. They may also cooperate to mob a predator such as a lion. The single calf (rarely twins) is born after 340 days' gestation, and is fiercely protected by the mother and often by other members of the herd.

HERD BEHAVIOR

Cape buffaloes are very gregarious and gather at times of plentiful food in herds of 2,000 or more. In the dry season, they split into smaller groups of females and young (including males up to 3 years), or bachelor bands of mature males; older males are more solitary. In any herd, large males dominate smaller ones and also any females.

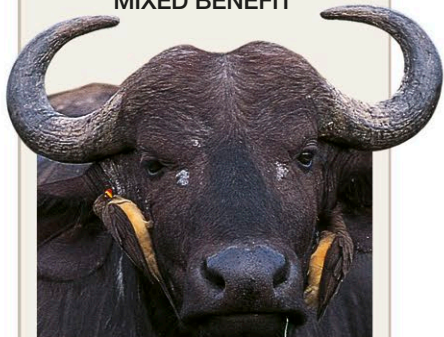


DARK COLORATION

The Cape buffalo has a sparse, dark brown coat, big, drooping, hair-fringed ears, a naked muzzle, a long tail, and large feet with rounded hooves.

tapering horn curves in C shape

MIXED BENEFIT



Buffaloes may be infested with lice, ticks, fleas, and similar skin parasites, which birds such as oxpeckers nip off to eat. The bird is fed, and the buffalo cleaned. However, the birds are also known to keep wounds open to feed on the blood, indicating a somewhat parasitic relationship.



Bos javanicus

Banteng



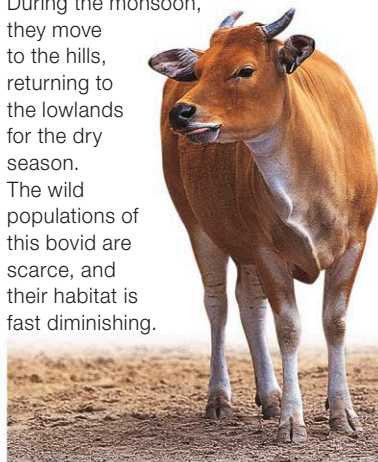
Location S.E. Asia

Length 6–7½ ft (1.8–2.3 m)
Tail 26–28 in (65–70 cm)
Weight 1,320–1,760 lb (600–800 kg)
Social unit Group
Status Endangered



Ancestor of the domestic banteng and resembling domestic cattle in overall form, the male (bull) banteng is black-brown to dark chestnut; the female (cow) and young are red-brown. All have white undersides, legs, and rump patches. The male's horns are up to 30 in (75 cm) long, angled outward, and

then upward; the female's are smaller and crescent-shaped. Banteng live in female-young herds of 2–40 with one adult male, or in bachelor herds. During the monsoon, they move to the hills, returning to the lowlands for the dry season. The wild populations of this bovid are scarce, and their habitat is fast diminishing.



Bos mutus

Yak



Location C. Asia

Length Up to 10–12¼ ft (3–3.8 m)
Tail Up to 39½ in (100 cm)
Weight Up to 660–2,200 lb (300–1,000 kg)
Social unit Individual/Group
Status Vulnerable

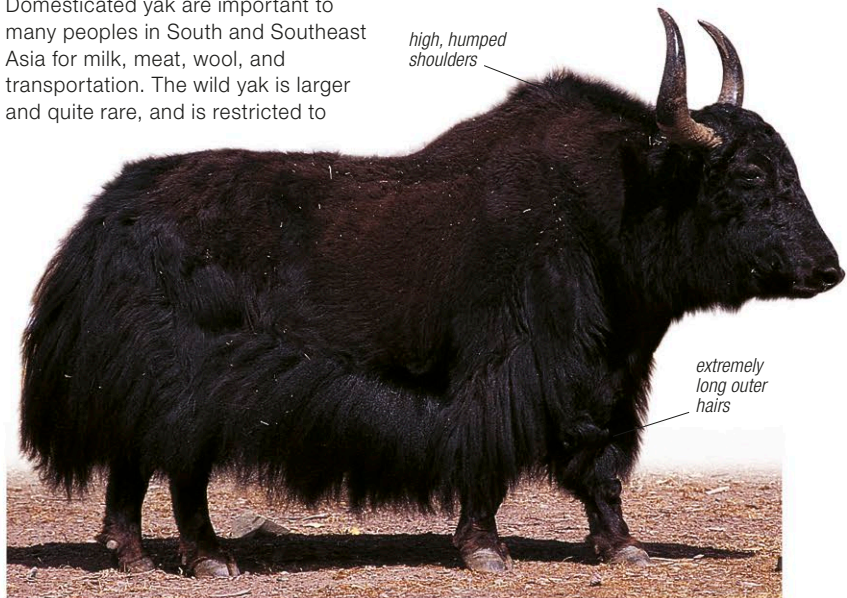


Domesticated yak are important to many peoples in South and Southeast Asia for milk, meat, wool, and transportation. The wild yak is larger and quite rare, and is restricted to

windy, desolate, bitterly cold steppes at an altitude of up to 19,800 ft (6,000 m), mainly from Kashmir (India) east to Tibet and Qinghai (China). Its dense undercoat of soft, close-matted hair is covered by generally dark brown to black outer hair. The yak grazes grasses, herbs, mosses, and lichens, and crunches ice or snow as a source of water. Females and young form herds, joined by males in the breeding season; otherwise, males form bachelor groups or live alone. A single calf is born every other year, after a gestation period of 258–270 days.

high, humped shoulders

extremely long outer hairs



Bos sauveli

Kouprey



Location S.E. Asia

Length 7–7¼ ft (2.1–2.2 m)
Tail 3¼–3½ ft (1–1.1 m)
Weight 1,544–1,985 lb (700–900 kg)
Social unit Variable
Status Critically endangered



The kouprey (also called Cambodian forest ox) is similar to domestic cattle in general proportions. The male may be black or dark brown with a pendulous dewlap (skin below lower jaw), and L-shaped horns that split at the tips after 3 years' growth. Females may be gray. Both sexes have off-white legs and pale underparts. They probably form small, loose herds. One of the world's most rare species, the kouprey was identified only in 1937 and is at risk from habitat loss, political instability, poaching, and many other dangers.